

STAGE EIGHT • SOFT SKILLS

FIRSTS

SESSION DEBRIEF / CLOSE-OUT SCRIPT

How to end each session, summarize, and bridge to what's next

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Session Debrief / Close-Out Script

Stage Eight • Soft Skills

WHY THIS MATTERS

A genuine close-out does three things every time: names what was actually accomplished, connects it forward to what's next, and gives participants a sense of closure. In this stage especially, closing well matters — sessions here can leave people in a genuinely reflective or vulnerable state, and a rushed ending undercuts that.

Close-Out Scripts

SESSION 1

Closing Session 1

"Today you built the foundation of communication: active listening, assertiveness, awareness of your own style, not interrupting, reading body language, inclusive practice, empathetic response, and listening for genuine understanding."

"Everything in the rest of this stage assumes these habits as a baseline. If today felt hard, that's completely normal — these are genuinely difficult skills, not obvious ones."

"Before next time: think of a real, moderate disagreement you could honestly reflect on. We'll use it in Session 2."

SESSION 2

Closing Session 2

"Today was inward-facing: empathy, emotional awareness, patience, perspective-taking, emotional vocabulary, regulation, cultural awareness, and a genuine values statement."

"Self-awareness isn't a one-time achievement — it's an ongoing practice. What you wrote today is a real starting point, not a finished picture."

"Before next time: know that Session 3 is our most emotionally demanding session. Come ready for real, direct feedback and conflict practice."

SESSION 3

Closing Session 3

"That was genuinely hard work: giving and receiving real feedback, resolving conflict, debriefing team tension, mediating, facilitating a feedback session, negotiating, and setting a boundary."

"If today brought up real discomfort, that's not a sign something went wrong — it's a sign you were actually practicing, not just discussing these skills abstractly."

"Before next time: Session 4 shifts to genuinely collaborative teamwork. You'll be working in a consistent small group throughout."

SESSION 4

Closing Session 4

"Today was real teamwork: taking on a genuine challenge, committing to a role, brainstorming, solving problems together, facilitating a decision, rotating roles, adapting to remote work, recognizing a peer, and logging a real decision's reasoning."

"Notice how much of today depended on the communication and emotional skills from Sessions 1 and 2 — teamwork is really those skills applied under real coordination pressure."

"Before next time: think of a topic you could speak on comfortably for 60–90 seconds, unprepared. We'll use it in Session 5."

SESSION 5

Closing Session 5

"Today was about showing up visibly: speaking confidence, adapting to a mixed audience, genuine networking, mentoring both ways, following up, reflecting on events, handling live questions, and motivational speaking."

"If any of today felt exposing, that's the nature of this specific set of skills — they only really develop through genuine, repeated practice in front of real people."

"Before next time: our final session is reflective. Come ready to look back honestly across this whole stage."

SESSION 6

Closing Session 6 (Stage Close)

"That's Stage Eight, complete. Over six sessions, you've built communication and listening, emotional intelligence, feedback and conflict skills, genuine teamwork, networking and public speaking, and now closed with growth mindset and resilience."

"This stage asked more of you interpersonally and emotionally than most others in this program. That's exactly why it matters — these are the skills that shape how far technical competence can actually take you."

"Before we close: name one specific soft skill you've genuinely grown in, with a real example, not just a general impression."

"Stage Nine picks up with English Vocabulary — a different kind of skill-building, more individual and technical, after this stage's heavily interpersonal work."